Phase 1 – Ideation: Resume-to-Interview Coach

Outskill AI Accelerator hackathon · drafted 29 Oct 2026 · follows the "Vibe Coding Hackathon Workbook", Phase 1 (Steps 1–4). Builds on `idea-selection/idea-scoring.md`. Skill tags (K1–K10) refer to the C15 course days in that file.

Step 1 – Product and user basics

1.1 Product one-liner

- **Product name (working):** RoleReady
- **One-liner:** For **job seekers with an interview coming up**, I am building **an AI interview coach that turns their resume and the target job description into a realistic mock interview, by text or voice, with scored, evidence-based feedback** so they can **walk in knowing which of their own stories to tell for this role and exactly what to fix.**

1.2 Who is this for

- **Primary user role:** Early- to mid-career job seeker (0–8 years' experience), including career switchers and upskillers, who has a specific interview in the next 1–14 days.
- **Where they use this (context):** On a laptop at home in the evening or at the weekend, right after they get shortlisted or receive the interview invite. Voice practice can also happen on a phone with headphones.
- **Top 3 pains today:**
  1. **Generic practice.** "Top 50 interview questions" lists and YouTube videos don't reflect their resume or this job description, so they rehearse the wrong things.
  2. **No honest feedback.** Friends are polite; paid human mock interviews are expensive and need scheduling. They can't tell whether an answer is actually good, or which project to talk about.
  3. **Freezing when speaking.** They can write a decent answer, but ramble or blank when asked out loud under time pressure. Typed practice alone doesn't fix that.

1.3 MVP success for this hackathon

- **By the end of 3 days a user should be able to:** sign in, upload a resume PDF and paste a job description, get 6 questions tailored to both, answer each one, and receive a score with "what worked / one fix / a stronger version" for every answer, saved as a session they can reopen.
- **Success metric for the demo:** From upload to first scored feedback in under 3 minutes, and 6/6 questions visibly tied to a specific resume line or JD requirement.

Step 2 – Deepen the problem with 5 Whys

2.1 Problem statement v0

Job seekers don't practise for interviews effectively.

2.2 5 Whys

Why #	Question	Our answer
1	Why is this a problem for your user?	They walk into interviews under-prepared for the questions this particular role will ask, and lose offers they are qualified for, often on "tell me about a time…" questions about their own work.
2	Why does that happen right now?	Prep is generic. They read question lists, but nobody maps *their* resume against *this* JD to predict the questions and pick the right stories. Human mock interviews are costly and hard to book at a few days' notice.
3	Why haven't existing tools solved this well?	The tools each cover part of the job. Yoodli mostly grades *delivery* (pace, filler words), not content. Huru is strong and free but centres on on-camera practice, with resume tailoring as a separate tool. Final Round AI leads with a live in-interview "copilot" (ethically contested) at $25–150/month, with many billing complaints. Google's free Interview Warmup was reportedly retired in 2026. Few tools check whether the answer used the right evidence from the candidate's own resume for the JD's requirements.
4	Why is your user still stuck?	Without feedback grounded in their own experience, they

Why #	Question	Our answer
		can't tell which story to use or whether an answer lands, so they repeat the same weak answers. Practising aloud alone feels awkward, so they skip it and only practise in writing.
5	Why does solving this now matter for them?	Interviews come with only days' notice and each one is scarce. A wasted interview can mean weeks more searching. More first rounds are also now recorded or AI-run screens, where spoken delivery matters even more.

2.3 Final problem statement

> **Job seekers with an interview days away can't get realistic, honest practice for that specific role. Question lists are generic, human mock interviews are costly and hard to book, and current AI tools grade delivery or generic answers rather than whether the candidate used the right evidence from their own resume for this job. So they walk in rehearsed on the wrong things.**

Reuse this line in prompts, the PRD and the demo.

Step 3 – Competitor scan and AI feature analysis

3.1 References

Screenshots: `phase1-ideation/competitor-screenshots/` (huru-home.png, yoodli-pricing.png, finalround-home.png), captured 29 Oct 2026.

Product / tool	Links or pages checked	What they do well (2 points)	What frustrates users (2 points)
Huru	huru.ai (home + pricing), huru.ai/compare, App Store reviews, theofferinbox.com review	1. Free for job seekers: unlimited mocks, live AI interviewer, 50k+ question library, questions from a pasted JD. 2. Scores every answer (relevance, structure, specificity, impact,	1. Reliability: app/extension friction reported (e.g. "start interview" shows a blank overlay). 2. Feedback can push formulaic, STAR-by-rote answers; weak for deep technical or

Product / tool	Links or pages checked	What they do well (2 points)	What frustrates users (2 points)
		articulation) and shows a stronger version.	company-fit judgement.
Yoodli	yoodli.ai/pricing, yoodli.ai/use-cases/interview-preparation	1. Realistic roleplay interviewers with dynamic follow-up questions. 2. Excellent delivery analytics: pacing, filler words, clarity, eye contact.	1. Grades *how* you speak, not whether the answer is relevant or well-structured for the role. 2. Free tier is limited; $8/mo for 10 roleplays a week, $20/mo for unlimited, and the product is shifting toward enterprise/sales teams.
Final Round AI	finalroundai.com (home, pricing), Trustpilot reviews, remotejobassistant.com review, Reddit r/interviews	1. Practice mode generates role-specific questions from the JD; well rated on Product Hunt. 2. Full loop: prepare → practise → automatic debrief.	1. Billing and refunds: many Trustpilot complaints (annual upfront charges, $150/mo plans, no human support). 2. Flagship live "Interview CoPilot" is unreliable in real calls and seen by recruiters as cheating.

Also noted: Google Interview Warmup (free, reportedly retired in 2026, leaving a gap for a free, simple tool); Pramp/Exponent (peer and technical mocks).

3.2 AI feature extraction

⭐ = potential differentiator for us.

Feature	What it does	Why users care	Which tool(s) have it
JD-tailored questions	Generates questions from a pasted job description	Practice matches the real interview	Huru, Final Round AI
Role question library	Large bank of questions by role	Quick start without a JD	Huru (50k+)
Live AI interviewer	Speaks questions,	Rehearses real	Huru, Yoodli

Feature	What it does	Why users care	Which tool(s) have it
(voice)	listens, asks follow-ups	pressure and speaking aloud	
Per-answer score with rubric	Scores relevance, structure, specificity, impact	Know if an answer is good, track change	Huru
Stronger version of answer	Rewrites the answer better	Concrete model to learn from	Huru
Delivery analytics	Pace, filler words, eye contact	Polishes how you come across	Yoodli, Huru
STAR coaching	Checks situation/task/action/result structure	Behavioural answers land	Huru, Final Round AI
Session debrief	Summary after practice	Know what to work on next	Final Round AI, Huru
Progress tracking	Scores across sessions	Motivation, proof of improvement	Huru, Yoodli
Resume builder / tailoring	Rewrites resume for a JD	One-stop job prep	Huru, Final Round AI
Live in-interview copilot	Suggests answers during a real interview	(Controversial)	Final Round AI
Multi-language, mobile, Chrome	Practice anywhere	Accessibility	Huru
⭐ **Resume-grounded questions with "why we're asking" tag**	Every question shows the resume line and JD requirement it targets	Trust, and they learn how interviewers read their resume	None found showing this explicitly
⭐ **Evidence check in feedback**	Feedback flags claims not backed by the resume and suggests a better story from *their own* experience	Content coaching, not generic rewrites	None found
⭐ **JD coverage map**	Shows which JD requirements the user has and hasn't yet evidenced in answers	Clear "what to prepare next"	None found
⭐ **Emailed report + book next practice**	n8n sends the session report via Gmail and adds a Calendar slot	Closes the loop outside the app	Partly (in-app debriefs only)

Feature	What it does	Why users care	Which tool(s) have it
⭐ **Company-research agent**	Adds 2–3 company-specific questions from public info	"Why us?" prep	Not prominent in the three

Patterns / common must-haves: JD-tailored questions, scored per-answer feedback with an improved version, spoken practice, and saved history. Every serious competitor has these, so we need them at a basic level; our edge is grounding everything in the user's own resume (⭐ rows).

Step 4 – MVP scope with MoSCoW

4.1 Feature dump

Sign-in · resume PDF upload + parsing · JD paste · tailored question set · "why we're asking" tags · text answers · scored feedback · stronger version · evidence check · session save + history · voice mock interview (Retell) · emailed report (n8n + Gmail) · JD coverage map · Pinecone question bank (RAG) · company-research agent · HeyGen/ElevenLabs clone interviewer intro · Calendar booking of next practice · progress chart · daily practice reminder · delivery analytics (pace/fillers) · video/eye-contact analysis · resume builder · live interview copilot · payments · team/university accounts · multi-language · custom MCP server · mobile app.

4.2 MoSCoW prioritisation

Feature	M	S	C	W	Differentiator?	Why placed here	Course skill
Sign-in (Supabase auth)	☑️	☐	☐	☐	–	Sessions must belong to a user	K8
Resume PDF upload + text extraction	☑️	☐	☐	☐	–	Core input; product fails without it	K9
Paste job description	☑️	☐	☐	☐	–	Core input	–

Feature	M	S	C	W	Differentiator?	Why placed here	Course skill
6 tailored questions with “why we’re asking” tag	☑️	☐	☐	☐	⭐	The main promise, and our visible edge	K1
Answer in text	☑️	☐	☐	☐	–	Simplest reliable way to complete the flow	–
Scored feedback: 4-criterion score, what worked, one fix, stronger version using their real resume facts (evidence check)	☑️	☐	☐	☐	⭐	Without feedback there is no coaching	K1
Save session + history list	☑️	☐	☐	☐	–	Required by the official idea brief	K8
Voice mock interview (Retell): asks aloud, transcribes, same feedback	☐	☑️	☐	☐	⭐	Fixes pain #3 and is the Day 6 centrepiece, but the text flow must work	K6

Feature	M	S	C	W	Differentiator?	Why placed here	Course skill
						first	
Email session report via n8n + Gmail	☐	☑️	☐	☐	⭐	Cheap, visible automation for the demo	K3, K7
JD coverage map	☐	☐	☑️	☐	⭐	Small add-on once feedback exists	K1
Pinecone question bank (RAG)	☐	☐	☑️	☐	–	Improves question quality; LLM alone is enough for v1	K4
Company-research agent (multi-agent)	☐	☐	☑️	☐	⭐	Strong showcase, but extra moving parts	K7
HeyGen/ ElevenLabs clone as interviewer intro	☐	☐	☑️	☐	–	Good for the Loom; not core	K2
Calendar booking of next practice	☐	☐	☑️	☐	–	Nice loop-closer, adds OAuth work	K7
Progress chart across sessions	☐	☐	☑️	☐	–	Needs several sessions to mean anything	–

Feature	M	S	C	W	Differentiator?	Why placed here	Course skill
Daily practice reminder	☐	☐	☑️	☐	–	Easy routine, low demo value	K10
Delivery analytics (pace, fillers)	☐	☐	☐	☑️	–	Yoodli's territory; not our edge	–
Video / eye-contact analysis	☐	☐	☐	☑️	–	Heavy, privacy-sensitive	–
Live in-interview copilot	☐	☐	☐	☑️	–	Ethically contested; we coach, we don't cheat	–
Resume builder	☐	☐	☐	☑️	–	Different product	–
Payments, team/university accounts	☐	☐	☐	☑️	–	Not needed to prove value	–
Multi-language, mobile app	☐	☐	☐	☑️	–	Scope	–
Custom MCP server	☐	☐	☐	☑️	–	Doesn't serve the end user	K5

4.3 Final MVP scope for the hackathon

- **Single must-have flow we commit to ship:** Sign in → upload resume PDF + paste JD → get 6 tailored questions, each tagged with the resume line / JD requirement it targets → answer in text → see per-answer score, what worked, one fix and a stronger version built from the user's own resume → session saved and reopenable from History.
- **Up to 2 should-haves:**

  - Voice mock interview with Retell (questions asked aloud, answers transcribed, same feedback). Fallback if Retell integration stalls: browser speech-to-text on the answer box.
  - n8n workflow that emails the session report via Gmail when a session is completed.
- **Parked deliberately (for later):**
  - Company-research agent + Pinecone question bank
  - HeyGen/ElevenLabs clone interviewer, Calendar booking, JD coverage map, progress chart

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Phase 1 – End checklist

- ☒ Final problem statement is clear (2.3)
- ☒ Primary user and context defined (1.2)
- ☒ Competitor screenshots + feature table done (3.1, 3.2)
- ☒ Features prioritised with MoSCoW (4.2)
- ☒ One must-have flow + up to 2 should-haves locked (4.3)

Notes for the team

- The 5 Whys and pains are our best draft from competitor research, not user interviews. If anyone can ask 2–3 job-seeking friends “how did you prep for your last interview?”, it will sharpen the demo story.
- Competitor prices and features were checked on 29 Oct 2026 from their own sites plus third-party reviews (Trustpilot, App Store, review blogs). Google Interview Warmup’s retirement comes from third-party reports.
- The official idea brief suggests Bolt + Supabase + a document parser + an LLM API. Phase 2 (architecture, PRD, starting prompt) should start from the flow in 4.3.